

INDIEFFERENTIAL



WHAT'S NEW?

by indiefferential

PIPER CONOLLY | SEPTEMBER VOL .3 2026

Piper Conolly

WELCOME TO INDIEFFERENTIAL

Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.

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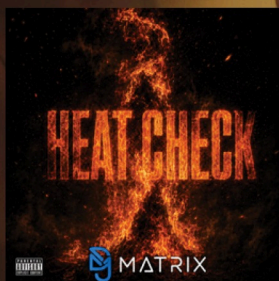


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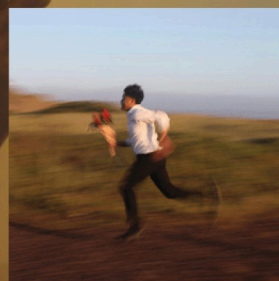
DJ Matrix turns a lost chapter into a dancefloor comeback

DJ Matrix has spent nearly four decades carrying the memory of an underground classic, and his return to music feels less like nostalgia than a continuation of unfinished business. His 1986 release, "Feed My Bass", became a staple of breakdance culture, earning an enduring following while Matrix was serving in the US Marines. The Gulf War soon interrupted his musical career, leaving the artist away from the spotlight for decades.

That changed when Egyptian Lover tracked him down and encouraged a return, resulting in "Hypnotic" in 2005. A collaboration with Beat Junkies founder I-Rock followed with "Feel My Bass (Reloaded)", giving the signature track a new lease on life while reconnecting Matrix with the audience that had never forgotten it.

Now comes "Heat Check", a more contemporary dancefloor statement that carries the confidence of an artist rediscovering his momentum. Matrix's electronic approach remains rooted in rhythm and physical energy, but the production reflects a willingness to move forward rather than simply recreate the past.

With plans for monthly singles leading toward a full album, Matrix is turning an unexpected second act into a sustained creative run. "Heat Check" captures that renewed purpose, bringing a veteran of early electronic culture back into the present with plenty of energy left to spend.



Kino Caliwag finds quiet beauty in the art of letting go

Kino Caliwag explores heartbreak through a sound that sits comfortably between indie pop, neo soul, and intimate singer songwriter music. With warm acoustic textures, soulful vocals, and reflective writing, Caliwag creates songs that treat romance and emotional change with honesty rather than melodrama.

"If I Die" opens a new chapter in that journey, focusing on the difficult acceptance that comes when someone you once imagined a future with is no longer part of it. The song carries the weight of deep attachment while gradually moving toward release, finding tenderness in the realization that letting go can also be an act of self preservation.

Influences from Daniel Caesar, Frank Ocean, and Bruno Major can be felt in the track's restrained emotional delivery and understated warmth, but Caliwag's approach remains personal. The production leaves space around the vocal, allowing the lyrics and subtle instrumental details to carry the emotional narrative.

Rather than presenting heartbreak as a single moment, "If I Die" captures the slower process of understanding, accepting, and rebuilding. It introduces an artist interested in the complicated space between love and loss, setting the tone for a broader musical journey about healing, self discovery, and finding yourself again.



EPIC NELSON chase endless summer with Beach Fever

EPIC NELSON lean into the brighter side of rock and roll with "Beach Fever", a spirited summer track built around soaring vocals, ringing guitar lines, and hooks that aim straight for the singalong instinct. The Bay Area band's latest release embraces the larger than life character of 1980s arena rock while keeping its blues rock foundation and modern melodic sensibility intact.

At the heart of the song is a simple fantasy, escaping routine, gathering the people you love, and finding somewhere warm enough to forget the clock. That carefree idea shapes the music itself, with vibrant harmonies and energetic guitar work creating the sensation of open roads, ocean air, and long evenings without an agenda.

Eric Nelson's vocals give the track its celebratory center, while the guitars provide much of its heat, moving between muscular riffs and expressive solos. Rather than treating nostalgia as a museum piece, EPIC NELSON use the sounds of classic arena rock as a launchpad for something deliberately joyful and immediate.

"Beach Fever" captures the band's instinct for music that brings people together. It is upbeat without losing its rock edge, polished enough for the studio but clearly built with the live stage in mind. For EPIC NELSON, summer becomes more than a setting, it becomes a state of mind.

LIVING IN DADELAND

Michael Cohen is a Miami- and D.C.-based singer-songwriter whose debut album, *Living in Dadeland*, blends intimate storytelling with indie folk-pop sensibilities. Its songs range from garage rock to Sinatra-esque ballads and everything in between.

Michael began writing songs in his 20s, driven more by the desire to express emotion than to follow traditional musical paths. After the jarring social dislocation of pandemic-era Washington, D.C., he relocated to Miami for what he thought would be a brief escape. What followed was a powerful romance, and an equally profound heartbreak, that inspired *Living in Dadeland*, a concept album charting love, loss, and the fragile beauty of redemption.

Living in Dadeland represents the most absorbing creative pursuit of Cohen's life. It is a document of heartbreak, but also of reinvention: the story of a songwriter who returned to music with renewed purpose and taught himself an entirely new creative language in order to tell the story he believed needed to be told.

For Michael Cohen, *Living in Dadeland* began with a story he felt compelled to tell. The narrative album traces the arc of a relationship through moments of joy, safety, heartbreak, bargaining, reflection, resignation, and ultimately redemption. Yet the story behind its creation is equally central to the project. After decades of writing songs largely outside of the music industry, Cohen found himself facing an unexpected challenge: if he wanted to fully realize the music he was hearing in his head, he would have to learn how to produce it himself.

Cohen's relationship with music began early. He fell in love with The Beatles as a child and later discovered Leonard Cohen's poetry, which inspired him to begin writing poems as a teenager. He eventually came to songwriting after picking up a nylon-string guitar in his twenties. Rather than pursuing technical mastery of the instrument, Cohen used it as a way to connect words and music.

In his late twenties, he formed the band The Invoices alongside several accomplished musicians, including Bill Williams. For several years, the group collaborated and performed together before eventually dissolving. Cohen continued writing songs afterward, but would spend decades without a band or regular musical collaborators.

The first seeds of *Living in Dadeland* emerged in late 2021. Recently out of a relationship and facing a lonely winter in pandemic-era Washington, D.C., Cohen temporarily relocated to Miami, where he began writing 'The Other Side of Winter.' The song captured a moment of

uncertainty and displacement, including the lyric: 'Feeling like I'm at a time in my life I don't know where I fit.'

A connection with Grammy-winning producer and multi-instrumentalist David Cabrera soon offered Cohen a glimpse of what his songwriting could become. After hearing an acoustic demo of 'The Other Side of Winter,' Cabrera returned it as a fully arranged recording.

Cohen was stunned by the transformation. 'After decades wandering in the musical wilderness, here was a fully realized version of something I had written,' he recalls. 'I wanted more.'

The album's emotional direction became clearer following an unexpected romance in Miami and its eventual collapse. Songs including 'Boyfriend' and 'Save My Love Tonight' capture the warmth and security of the relationship, while 'My Evil Twin' and 'Gray April Day' emerged from its painful aftermath.

As the songs accumulated, Cohen realized they demanded more than acoustic demos. Without a band or the financial and logistical means to assemble one for every track, he turned toward production.

In January 2024, Cohen began learning Logic Pro from scratch. He bought a keyboard and immersed himself in hundreds of hours of tutorials covering drum programming, recording, processing, and mixing. Progress was slow, and there were moments when he nearly abandoned the effort entirely.

The breakthrough came unexpectedly while working on 'My Evil Twin.' A simple drum loop provided the foundation, followed by bass, guitar, organ, and vocals. For the first time, Cohen had constructed a full-band recording himself.

"Finally, after decades of working alone, I had my collaborators," he says. "I just had to teach myself to make them play what I wanted."

As his production skills developed, *Living in Dadeland* increasingly revealed itself as a cohesive narrative. The album opens from two perspectives: 'Prelude North: The Other Side of Winter' tells Cohen's side of the story, while 'Prelude South: Living in Dadeland' imagines the perspective of the woman at the center of the relationship.

From there, the songs move through the relationship's emotional progression, from love and safety to shock and heartbreak, followed by processing, insight, resignation, and redemption. The project also features

significant contributions from musicians and collaborators who helped shape its sound. David Cabrera arranged 'Prelude North: The Other Side of Winter,' while Cohen's former bandmate Bill Williams arranged 'Gray April Day.' Randy Byrnes contributed piano and organ to 'Save My Love Tonight,' while Olya Gram, Riccardo Mazzaglia, and Peter Voronov added performances throughout the album. Veteran mastering engineer Alan Douches ultimately mastered the finished project.

Although Cohen initially intended to release the album much earlier, the project continued evolving as his skills developed. What began as a collection of rough demos grew into a much more ambitious production. Even after submitting the album for release in late 2025, Cohen pulled it back following a naming issue and used the additional time to revisit several songs, arrangements, and mixes.

The final months of work brought substantial revisions to 'River of Secrets,' both Preludes, and 'My Evil Twin,' along with the mastering process that helped bring the album to completion. By the end, *Living in Dadeland* had become more than a collection of songs about heartbreak. The project itself became intertwined with questions about creativity, perseverance, and whether transforming painful experiences into art can become part of healing.

Cohen acknowledges that repeatedly revisiting some of the most difficult moments of his life was not always therapeutic. 'I often wondered whether the process was helping or hurting,' he says. 'I'm still not sure. But I am sure that there's something incredibly life affirming and uplifting about turning your darkest moments into something you can step back from and appreciate artistically.'

That idea ultimately sits at the heart of *Living in Dadeland*: the possibility of finding something meaningful within experiences that initially feel impossible to understand. "When someone breaks your heart, make art," Cohen says, summarizing the philosophy that carried him through the project.

Now complete, *Living in Dadeland* represents the most absorbing creative pursuit of Cohen's life. It is a document of heartbreak, but also of reinvention: the story of a songwriter who returned to music with renewed purpose and taught himself an entirely new creative language in order to tell the story he believed needed to be told.



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SPOTLIGHT

THE MAN THAT I AM: ANTHONY CASUCCIO'S REFINED R&B MELODIES



With a catalog of over three decades under his belt, Anthony Casuccio brings a unique blend of Alt/Pop textures and organic instrumentation to the world with his latest single, 'The Man That I Am.' This track is a testament to Casuccio's production prowess, as he crafts contemporary music that feels both modern and timeless. The artist has made significant contributions in the audio industry, with nominations for three Grammy Awards, gold record status, and placements in numerous TV shows and commercials. His work spans across various genres, including his most recent remastering of Johnny Cash's albums, which placed him on a pedestal among respected producers like Tony Bennet and Roy Orbison. As both a producer and songwriter, Casuccio has been instrumental in leading his band A&L to success with songs topping multiple charts worldwide. His versatility is further evident through the nine top 20 hits he secured for the band alone, as well as four of his solo works reaching the top 20 on various UK indie music charts.

THE STORY

Casuccio's latest release, a song titled 'Life Goes On,' resonated

deeply with fans in Europe. It hit 1 on the UK Independent charts and garnered significant media coverage. Another notable single from his discography, 'The Rockstar,' was equally impactful when it reached its peak at 2 on Euro charts, marking Casuccio's fifth top 5 single in Europe. His most recent effort, 'Don't Say Goodbye,' took him to the pinnacle of success with a strong performance at 3 on the European Independent music charts.

Casuccio's production skills extend far beyond his singles and hits; they are integral to his work as an engineer, producer, and songwriter for his various projects. His latest single showcases his distinctive guitar work, a hallmark that has been integral to his success in the industry. Casuccio's unique style and creativity continue to inspire and influence new generations of music makers, making him a must-watch figure in the world of contemporary R&B and Pop.



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DEEP DIVE

A Seat in the Dark: The Dead Hearts Dive Into Emotional Intensity and Heavy Guitars



For those who have felt lost or adrift, The Dead Hearts are here to remind us that we're not alone. With their latest single 'In The Back Seat', they masterfully tap into the raw emotions of life's inevitable moments when control feels entirely out of our hands, like being a passenger in a car with no say over where it is heading. This new track marks the beginning of a powerful chapter for The Dead Hearts, who have been crafting their unique sound since forming in Lublin, Poland in 2020.

The band's debut album 'Pliet Goes On' cemented their place as an alternative rock/post-grunge act with influences rooted in the late 90s and early 2000s. Influences like Breaking Benjamin,

Seether, Deftones, and Alter Bridge have all influenced The Dead Hearts, who blend these genres into their own distinctive sound. In 'In The Back Seat', they fuse heavy guitars with melodic vocals, a memorable chorus, and an intense breakdown, balancing the band's heavier side with a strong emotional core.

Lead guitarist Damian Lipiński led the creation of this new single. It is part of the band's ongoing journey following their 2025 debut album 'Pliet Goes On', and it arrives on September 25, 2026, accompanied by an official music video. With a sound that feels both raw and intense, The Dead Hearts continue to push boundaries within the alternative metal/post-grunge genre.

"Lead guitarist Damian Lipiński led the creation of this new single."

Lipiński's vision is clear: he wants listeners to feel every ounce of this track's emotional depth. From the opening chords to the closing notes, 'In The Back Seat' is a testament to the band's unique sound and raw emotion. It stands as a powerful reminder that even in moments when life feels entirely out of control, there is strength found within each song they create, and their next single is a testament to just that.

SCENE REPORT

FIRST LIGHT: RICHARD GREEN'S ORCHESTRAL RETURN TO CHILDHOOD'S PROMISE



Richard Green, the Milan-based musician and composer, is embarking on a journey of remarkable ambition, one that promises to redefine the landscape of contemporary classical music. His latest release, “Age of Dreams,” unveiled on December 22nd, 2024, represents the first installment in an expansive three-part narrative, ‘A Journey’, intended to chart the course of human experience from its nascent beginnings to its final echoes. This project isn't simply a collection of songs; it's a meticulously crafted conceptual arc, beginning with the vibrant innocence captured within “First Light.”

The single itself appears on the aforementioned EP, equally titled “First Light,” and immediately establishes Green's unique vision. He describes the track as an attempt to distill the essence

of youth, that crucial ‘age of dreams,’ saturated with limitless possibility, a feeling often lost to the pragmatic concerns of adulthood. This deeply personal exploration is anchored by a masterful fusion of classical piano and string arrangements, subtly interwoven with contemporary sensibilities, resulting in a release brimming with both artistic significance and emotional resonance.

Green's musical pedigree speaks volumes to this ambitious undertaking. Spending eleven formative years in London, culminating in a music degree, profoundly shaped his stylistic development. His early work, including the 2020 single “Dark Horses,” already hinted at an impressive versatility across diverse genres, a trend that has now culminated in what he considers his most significant artistic endeavor. This

project began as a singular EP but quickly evolved into a sprawling trilogy: “A Journey” and “The Circle Closes,” both released in 2024, with “First Light” completing the initial set in 2025.

What truly distinguishes Richard Green is his inherent adaptability. He's demonstrated this consistently throughout his career, a trait that will continue to manifest as he prepares for a diverse range of projects slated for release in 2026. The first will be a venture into melodic electro/tech music, a complex and richly layered soundscape, while the second will embrace the raw energy of beats, blending funk, rock, electro, and hip-hop elements with masterful precision. This continued evolution suggests an artist relentlessly committed to pushing boundaries and exploring new sonic territories.



Profile

Clara Quilichini has crafted a powerful and poignant anthem titled "Off"



In an era where the world often seems disconnected from its most vulnerable members, Clara Quilichini has crafted a powerful and poignant anthem titled 'Off,' released on World Peace Day. The song's genesis is deeply personal, rooted in the artist's experiences witnessing the devastating realities of war abroad and returning to her home in France with an unshakeable sense of disquiet: how does one maintain normalcy amidst such intense suffering elsewhere?

'Off' is not merely a critique but also a beacon of hope. It reflects upon humanity's resilience, its capacity for compassion, and the enduring beauty of kindness and solidarity. Quilichini masterfully integrates this theme into her music with an innovative vocal structure: midway through the song, a children's choir enters, representing innocent lives caught in warzones and united under one harmonious refrain.

This is followed by a crescendo where these voices are joined by a larger ensemble of men and women, creating a collective symphony that underscores humanity's ability to transcend even the darkest circumstances. This final section encapsulates Quilichini's belief in the enduring strength found within communities and the vital role they play in sustaining hope.

The song's central question, "How do you rise when little ones are falling?", resonates with a depth of empathy and humanity rarely heard in

contemporary music. It does not offer simple answers but instead finds its resolution in the collective act of creation, connection, and continued care.

Quilichini's musical journey is marked by her versatility across various mediums including film, television, and voice acting, yet she has always approached storytelling through emotion and vulnerability. 'Off' marks a significant step towards her debut full-length album, which promises to further explore intimate human experiences through songwriting.

This single stands as more than just music; it's an emotional journey that touches on the universal struggles of humanity and its inherent capacity for solidarity in adversity. In this sense, Clara Quilichini has created a musical monument that not only reflects her personal journey but also serves as a rallying cry for those seeking meaning amidst despair.



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FIRST LISTEN

The Sound of a Soul-Smashed Heart Unveiled: Noëlle Rose's 'In or Out' EP Explores Emotionally Honest Songwriting

Noëlle Rose is emerging as an artist with a unique sound and visual identity that speaks to the heart. Her debut five-track EP, titled 'In or Out,' offers a glimpse into her intimate world of love, heartbreak, healing, and self-discovery. The EP features four songs that are rich in emotion and production quality; each track is a testament to Noëlle Rose's remarkable songwriting skills. This release marks an exciting new chapter for the artist, her first outside of an album format, and showcases her ability to capture real moments of life through compelling music. Noëlle Rose's voice, which is both warm and soulful, fits perfectly over clean pop production that gives the EP an intimate and comforting feel.

The EP begins with 'Heaven in His Eyes,' a delightful piece of romantic optimism that sets a lovely and hopeful tone for the rest of the songs. It's followed by the title track 'In or Out,' which expertly captures the playful and uncertain nature of relationships, bringing to life a sense of energy through infectious melodies. Noëlle Rose takes listeners on an emotional journey with her next song, 'The Lover I Once Had (Dance),'

featuring great vocals and catchy rhythms that make it stand out.

THE STORY

Perhaps my personal favorite is 'Ready to Love,' which offers a beautiful slice of vulnerability that feels incredibly real. The song's open, patient pace lets the singer's vocals carry the emotional message beautifully, making it resonate deeply with listeners. Closing the EP are two powerful tracks: 'I miss you (Rest in Peace),' which deals with deep loss in a sincere and moving way, and leaves one in quiet reflection after the music stops.

Noëlle Rose's debut release is truly heartfelt and unforced; her authenticity shines through each song. The emotional honesty of these songs connects deeply with listeners, offering comfort and hope. This EP not only sets Noëlle Rose apart as a captivating artist but also showcases the growth in her songwriting over time.

In just five tracks, Noëlle Rose delivers an intimate and emotionally resonant journey

through love, heartbreak, healing, and self-discovery. Her debut release should be on everyone's radar; whether they are fans of soul-pop or simply appreciate authentic storytelling in music, 'In or Out' is a must-listen for anyone looking to connect with their own experiences through Noëlle Rose's music.

Noëlle Rose's 'In or Out' EP is more than just entertainment, each song serves as a reminder that beauty can be found in every chapter of life's journey. Her artistry and the connections she fosters through her music make her an artist to watch, not only for this release but also for what's yet to come.

If you appreciate honest and heartfelt pop songs, Noëlle Rose is worth following on her music platforms and social media. She consistently delivers authentic and deeply personal moments that are as relatable as they are inspiring. Follow her journey now and stay updated with what she has planned for the rest of this year. The world of soul-pop is richer because of artists like Noëlle Rose, and supporting them ensures a vibrant future for all of us in music.





The My Plan EP: A Timeless Melody Crafted from Global Influences

Krey Galin, the dynamic artist hailing from Recife, Brazil, has been captivating audiences with a distinctive approach to music that bridges cultures and languages. With a collaborative spirit at the heart of their creative process, Galin works closely with a dedicated team and studio artists from Brazil to craft authentic sounds that resonate deeply with listeners. Drawing inspiration from global experiences, including memorable travels to the Netherlands, Galin's artistry reflects a worldview shaped by diverse influences and international friendships. What truly sets this Recife-based musician apart is an unwavering commitment to authenticity and the belief that great music transcends borders, embracing contributions from talented individuals regardless of origin to create something genuinely special.

Released on 20th February 2026, the 'My Plan' EP showcases music that has aged like fine wine, growing more valuable with time. Originally conceived as a straightforward pop record before K-pop dominated global charts, this collection has evolved into something truly special,

a body of work that listeners consistently described as having K-pop sensibilities before the genre exploded worldwide. Recorded in Georgia and written by key contributor Emerson, who initiated this musical journey, the EP features tracks that have proven their staying power by captivating ears in the studio for years.

The 'My Plan' EP stands as testament to the power of patience in creativity, with songs that never grew old even as their creators matured around them. This release marks Krey Galin's continued evolution as an artist and a leader in the global music scene, where they've found a unique voice and have crafted a body of work that reflects the vibrant tapestry of their musical upbringing and travels.

Galin's latest venture is a testament to her commitment to creating authentic sounds, blending influences from Brazil, Europe, and beyond. The EP showcases Krey Galin's knack for infusing catchy hooks with nuanced storytelling, resulting in tracks that are both relatable and captivating. The collaborative nature of their work ensures that each element of

the 'My Plan' EP feels like a cohesive whole, reflecting the collective vision of the artist and her team.

In an industry where rapid change is often prioritized over artistic integrity, Krey Galin stands out as an example of what can be achieved through dedication and a willingness to incorporate diverse perspectives. Her latest release serves as a reminder that sometimes the most timeless music emerges from the simplest ideas, honed over time by a team of talented individuals working in harmony.

As 'My Plan' EP captures its listeners with its polished production quality and emotional depth, it becomes clear why this collection is not just an artistic achievement but also a significant moment in the evolution of Krey Galin's musical journey. The EP represents more than just another chapter in her career; it's a testament to the power of patience and a belief that great music can connect people across cultures through shared humanity.



THE PERFECT SPELL: KONRAD KINARD'S DARK RENAISSANCE

In a bold move that reimagines an iconic piece of music history, Konrad Kinard has unveiled his interpretation of Nina Simone's 'I Put A Spell On You,' and it promises to captivate listeners with its fresh take on a classic. The Texas-born artist is set to release this compelling track through Incinerate Media on September 18, 2026, marking a significant shift in his musical landscape. This rendition not only reinterprets the song's structure but also elevates it with layers of emotion and intensity that pay homage to Nina Simone's original while infusing it with Kinard's own distinct voice and sensibilities.

A Graduate of the University of North Texas, Konrad Kinard has built a rich career as a composer, musician, and interdisciplinary performer. His work in New York's downtown scene has introduced him to luminaries like Bettina Köster (Malaria), Rhys Chatham, Glenn Branca, La La La Human Steps, The Woodentops, Arthur Russell, and Scott Walker. These associations have not only honed his skills but also provided a platform for exploring new frontiers in music.

Kinard's recent album, 'War I s Family,' presented with over 20 tracks, demonstrates his versatility as a multi-instrumentalist who handles voice, electronics, piano, and gamelan. Collaborations with notable figures such as trombonist Benji Arnold and percussionist Teruki Chan further attest to his ability to craft dynamic and multifaceted musical experiences. The project's production is entirely handled by Kinard himself for Incinerate Media.

The track's unconventional recording methods, which were implemented during the 2020 outbreak when live performances were limited, pushed his collaborators into creative territories

they hadn't previously explored. This approach has resulted in a sound that captures not just the zeitgeist of today but also the timeless essence of Kinard's interpretation.

"These associations have not only honed his skills but also provided a platform for exploring new frontiers in music."

Boston saxophonist Michael Caglianone describes this version as having 'the perfect amount of sexy/creepy.' The song, however, is more than its surface level. Kinard's artistic vision seeks to strip back industrial textures and embrace simple yet profound truths found in the spaces between sounds, a testament to his commitment to a minimalist yet richly textured style.

With each performance, Kinard delves into new genres and explores different mediums, such as dance works and live acts. His recent work with 'War I s Family' underscores this creative evolution, moving from densely layered string arrangements to more stripped-down jazz-industrial sounds that invite listeners to immerse themselves in a world where silence is just as important as sound.

As the release of 'I Put A Spell On You' draws near, it's clear that Konrad Kinard is poised for new artistic adventures. This boundary-pushing interpretation of an old classic not only stands out in his discography but also highlights his potential to continue pushing the boundaries of what we expect from contemporary music.

BEHIND THE RECORD



FROM AMNESIA TO ALIEN WORLDS: THE IMMERSIVE JOURNEY OF SPACE CADET 56



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In a multimedia landscape where creativity often clashes with conventional music formats, Space Cadet 56 stands as an extraordinary beacon. This unique project marries the vivid world of an illustrated novel with over 30 original pop-rock songs, each chapter punctuated by its own dedicated track. The artist behind this imaginative journey is James Tottle, a multimedia maestro whose talents span from author and illustrator to guitarist and vocalist. The result? An immersive audiovisual experience that transforms a story into something truly unforgettable.

James Tottle's creative vision for Space Cadet 56 began in the late nineties, following a life-changing event: he survived a heart transplant in 1997. This pivotal moment would later fuel his imagination as he crafted a tale of amnesia and mystery set against the backdrop of a failed Mars mission. The protagonist, Patient 56, an individual without memory, becomes the key to unraveling an enigmatic narrative.

Tottle's work is more than just music; it's a testament to his unique blend of storytelling, visual art, and musical

pro prowess. His ability to weave together emotions through song has earned him a reputation as one of the most distinctive figures in contemporary pop-rock. Each track in Space Cadet 56 isn't merely an auditory accompaniment but rather a crucial element that complements the story's narrative arc.

As the project progresses, Tottle's music evolves from vibrant and uplifting tunes to more somber compositions that delve into darker moments within the story. This depth of emotion is integral to his artistic vision, allowing listeners to feel intimately connected with each character. Whether Patient 56 faces challenges or navigates through a fantastical adventure, Tottle's songs serve as powerful allies in understanding the human experience and its complexities.

What truly sets Space Cadet 56 apart from other multimedia projects is the cohesive ecosystem that surrounds it. James' role extends beyond composition; he is actively involved in writing, illustrating, performing, and even producing his own music. This multifaceted approach not only enriches the experience but also demonstrates a

commitment to ensuring every element of the project feels seamlessly integrated.

Fans of pop-rock are in for an extraordinary treat with Space Cadet 56, a musical universe that transcends boundaries between art forms and genres. The latest release offers a snapshot into Tottle's creative journey, inviting listeners to embark on this mind-expanding adventure through music. Whether you're a seasoned fan of James' work or looking to discover new sounds, Space Cadet 56 promises an immersive listening experience that is both captivating and thought-provoking.

As we navigate the intricate tapestry of stories within Space Cadet 56, Tottle's unique voice emerges as a guiding light. His journey from patient with amnesia to a creator bringing worlds to life through music illustrates the power of perseverance and imagination. For those seeking an unconventional but captivating musical experience, Space Cadet 56 is more than just entertainment, it's a testament to what can be achieved when different disciplines come together in perfect harmony.

Long Read

Dream Folk Emerges: Dulldrums Unveil "If I'd Known"



The echoes of past projects resonate within the nascent soundscape of Dulldrums, a Manchester-based musical venture forged from the ashes of Mewn. Matt and Rachel, formerly bound by years of dedicated effort with their previous band, have established a distinct creative identity built on a compelling blend of introspective songwriting and atmospheric production. Their debut single, "If I'd Known," marks a significant shift, a deliberate move towards greater artistic freedom while retaining the core values that drove their earlier work. As they articulate, "The project was created after Mewn ended. Mewn had been going for years and we'd always put so much time into it, often practising twice at a weekend and not having much of a social life outside of it. We entered a different phase of our life and wanted a different kind of project that would give us more freedom but still enable us to take creating music just as seriously." The luxury afforded by their domestic partnership, the ability to create music together at home, proves crucial to this new approach. Despite now engaging with a full band for live performances, the initial genesis of Dulldrums was fundamentally a two-person operation. This collaborative process is strikingly evident in the creation of "If I'd Known," a track initially conceived as a traditional folk ballad centered around Matt and Rachel's shared skill on classical guitar. The intention was to infuse this foundation with a dreamlike quality, subsequently layering atmospheric synths to amplify the song's ethereal mood.

The band's self-described genre, "Dream Folk," encapsulates this ambition perfectly; a genre that draws heavily from folk sensibilities but expands outwards to encompass a wider range of influences. In the studio, careful attention was paid to adding contemporary textures, notably synth bass and subtly psychedelic guitar bends, resulting in a piece that balances timeless melodic elements with a distinctly modern edge. "The lyrics are about regret, loss and ignorance," they reveal, hinting at the core emotional themes driving the project's trajectory.

The recording of their forthcoming EP represents an even more deliberate exercise in layered sound design. Utilizing the expertise of producer Shane, the duo meticulously built upon their initial framework, adding instrumentation gradually to fully realize the song's potential. Despite their versatility, Rachel's background as a classical guitarist now extending to occasional electric work, and Matt proficiently handling both lead guitar and synth, the band acknowledges the necessity of incorporating elements reminiscent of The Velvet Underground, primarily through simple, dynamic percussion. Ultimately, Dulldrums represents not just a return to music-making but a considered evolution, a project shaped by experience, collaboration, and an unwavering commitment to crafting immersive sonic journeys.

FEATURE

A Beacon of Hope in Times of Tragedy: Dr. Judy Kuriansky & Russell Daisey's 'Towers of Light'

Towers of Light

Lyrics by Dr. Judy Kuriansky
and Russell Daisey



As the world marks the 25th anniversary of September 11, 2026, a song that emerged from the ashes offers a poignant message of healing and hope. 'Towers of Light,' composed by Dr. Judy Kuriansky & Russell Daisey, has transcended its original purpose to become an enduring testament to resilience and remembrance across five continents over two decades.

Written in response to the September 11 attacks, the song's origins are deeply personal for both artist and composer. For psychologist Dr. Judy Kuriansky, Ground Zero was more than a distant memory; it was her immediate reality as she served at the Family Assistance Center providing psychological support to responders, survivors, and families.

Kuriansky's experience at Ground Zero inspired 'Towers of Light,' an anthem that speaks not just to those who lost loved ones on 9/11 but also to communities navigating loss and trauma. The song's imagery of light rising above darkness is a powerful metaphor for transcendence, unity, and the enduring memory of those lost.

Composer Russell Daisey's role in 'Towers of Light' was instrumental, as he crafted the music that underpins this poignant reflection on suffering. His collaboration with Kuriansky marked more than just artistic partnership; it was a shared mission to create something meaningful and universal from their personal experiences.

Their work has seen them perform 'Towers of Light' in settings ranging from New York memorial ceremonies to global peace summits, where they have stood alongside esteemed figures like the Dalai Lama, Archbishop Desmond Tutu,

and Betty Williams. The song's message has resonated with audiences on a universal level, transcending cultural boundaries.

One particularly memorable moment came during the Hiroshima International Peace Summit in 2006. Kuriansky and Daisey joined HH the Dalai Lama, Archbishop Desmond Tutu, and Betty Williams onstage to perform 'Towers of Light.' Their powerful rendition not only captured the hearts of these esteemed speakers but also underscored the song's broader significance, beyond New York's Ground Zero.

Over time, 'Towers of Light' has evolved into more than a memorial song for 9/11. Its message of resilience and unity has connected communities facing various forms of collective trauma, from natural disasters to war. In Japan, the song found new life, with Japanese collaborators bringing it to sacred spaces like churches and Buddhist temples.

Its significance extends beyond performances. 'Towers of Light' has been used as an educational tool in classrooms across America, helping students process difficult experiences and foster interfaith understanding. This cross-cultural engagement has further enriched the song's message, making it a beacon of hope for generations to come.

As Dr. Kuriansky and Daisey continue their journey with 'Towers of Light,' they remain committed to using music as a bridge between communities, bringing comfort and solace through shared experiences of grief, trauma, and healing. Their song stands as a testament not just to one tragic event but to the enduring spirit of hope that can emerge from darkness.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

SPOTLIGHT

MEDITATING ON STAGNATION: SERAH'S CINEMATIC MELODIC BASS JOURNEY



Los Angeles-based artist and Lyra Records founder Natalie Demary has unveiled a sonic meditation of sorts with her debut single, 'Going Nowhere.' Heralded by the melodic dubstep, melodic trap, and cinematic scoring that defined SERAh's previous work in the melodic bass scene, the track serves as both a lyrical portrait and an auditory journey through emotional stagnation. It's a world where familiar pulls of a loop feel impossible to break, while surrendering to inertia offers a sense of strange peace, all within a rich sonic landscape that balances intimacy with expansive layers of orchestral instruments and cinematic scoring textures. 'Going Nowhere' is the first public expression of SERAh's Cinematic

Universe (SCU), a 20-chapter sci-fi narrative world at the heart of the project. Built on themes of rejection of false resolution, where much of the bass music landscape traffics in catharsis and triumph, SERAh's approach offers listeners company rather than answers. The project draws on the Magician archetype: transmutation of pain into beauty through dark, emotional depth with high energy. Every release comes with its own immersive video that is part of a larger sci-fi/fantasy narrative told via Lyra's World saga, with future sequels and spinoffs planned.

SERAh has already made her mark in the bass music world: she recently earned slots on Bass Euphoria's mainstage set as

well as Camp Elements. Her debut EP is currently in development by her independent label, Lyra Records. 'Going Nowhere' is available now across all major streaming platforms including Spotify, Apple Music, Tidal, and SoundCloud.

SERAh's identity lies not only in her tracks but also in the unique Cinematic Universe she's crafting: a world where every step, every release is integral to a larger narrative. Her music isn't merely entertainment, it's an invitation into a deeper conversation about emotion, creativity, and the journey of artistic expression. With 'Going Nowhere' as its launch point, SERAh continues to pave her own unique path in the melodic bass scene.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

DEEP DIVE

Memory Jar: Harridan's Surreal Experiment in Dissonance and Suspense

Experimental piano/vocal artist Harridan makes her debut with *Memory Jar*, a single that promises to be both mesmerizing and unsettling. Drawing together indie roots and classical influences, Kate Proudlove crafts a sound world that defies easy categorization, combining elements of art song, experimental pop, and alternative music into something uniquely her own.

Memory Jar begins as an experiment in limitation. At its core is a minimalist piano figure that serves as the foundation for the track. From here, Proudlove builds with layers of dissonant melody and modulated backing vocals, creating a sense of suspended time and space. The result is a piece that feels both hauntingly familiar and perpetually shifting.

Memory Jar moves like memory itself: it circles, repeats, disappears, and returns in altered form. This effect is achieved through sparse harmonic movement and dissonant melodic phrases that subtly distort the song's delicate surface. Rather than providing a straightforward narrative, *Memory Jar* invites listeners to navigate its disjointed structure and fragmented ideas.

As an art project rather than a full album, *Memory Jar* serves as a tantalizing taste of what is to come from Harridan. The single's sparse production quality and innovative approach offer a glimpse into the experimental side of Kate Proudlove's creative vision. With *Memory Jar*, she crafts a piece that feels both hauntingly beautiful and profoundly unsettling, qualities that seem essential in capturing the elusive nature of memory itself.

"Memory Jar begins as an experiment in limitation."

Proudlove's project draws upon her dual background as a pianist and vocalist, resulting in music that is both intimate and expansive. By merging these disparate influences into a cohesive sound, she creates a space where art song, experimental pop, and alternative genres can coexist harmoniously, or at least unsettlingly. *Memory Jar* stands out for its ability to convey the complex emotions and elusive nature of memory through subtle sonic manipulations.

Harridan's debut single, *Memory Jar*, is an exercise in restraint and imagination. It serves as a perfect introduction to the creative mind behind this project, a musician who pushes boundaries while maintaining a keen sense of emotional depth. As listeners navigate the fragmented landscape that is *Memory Jar*, they will find themselves both fascinated and unsettled by the journey ahead.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

Scene Report

Nights Like This: Jordan Bakewell's Heartfelt R&B Resonance

An emerging force in the UK music scene, Jordan Bakewell is carving out a distinct niche with his blend of catchy R&B and pop. His latest single, 'Nights Like This,' released on July 31, 2026, stands as a testament to his ability to connect deeply with listeners through honest storytelling and evocative melodies that evoke meaningful memories and emotions. The song is an intimate yet powerful piece of art, capturing the essence of late-night drives after gigs and offering relatable insights into cherished moments and connections.

Jordan Bakewell's journey as a musician began in his hometown of Leicester, where he drew inspiration from local music legends like Justin Bieber and Usher. His sound is a masterful fusion of R&B, soul, and pop, with standout tracks such as 'Freaky' featuring Grammy-nominated singer-songwriter Concepcion and the collaborative effort 'Little Bit.' This track received recognition when it was named BBC Introducing's Track of the Week.

THE STORY

Nights Like This serves as a poignant reminder of those late-night drives after gigs. Written entirely by Jordan Bakewell, the song draws from personal experiences, blending his unique style with a polished production that maintains an authentic edge. The track is both relatable and universal, making it accessible to fans across different demographics. Whether you're reminiscing about a summer evening or sharing

memories with someone special, 'Nights Like This' encapsulates the essence of meaningful connections and the magic of unforgettable moments.

The music industry has taken notice of Jordan Bakewell's talent. His collaboration with Sean Kingston promises to expand his reach even further, bringing together fresh voices in R&B and pop for a dynamic new sound. With 'Nights Like This,' Jordan continues to solidify his place in the scene as an artist who crafts songs that feel both personal and universal.

As he steps into the spotlight with this latest release, Jordan Bakewell remains true to his roots while embracing contemporary influences. His creative process is a testament to his dedication, capturing intimate moments through writing and recording in his home studio, closely collaborating on production, and engaging deeply with listeners through performance. At festivals, venues, and events across the country, Jordan showcases his ability to connect emotionally with audiences, proving that his unique sound has not only captured hearts but also won over critics and fans alike.

'Nights Like This' marks a significant milestone in Jordan Bakewell's career. By blending personal emotion with contemporary production quality, he continues to push boundaries and create music that feels genuine and deeply resonant. As the artist grows both musically and personally, his journey reflects a commitment to authenticity and an unwavering dedication to creating songs that become part of listeners' own stories.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

PROFILE

THE SOFT VOICE LEADS THE WAY: ALEX CATCHINGS' OFF-RAMP

He might have thought his academic life had relegated him to a second-class existence, but Alex Catchings has found his true calling in music. The 35-year-old singer-songwriter from Southern California turned his back on early dreams of stardom and instead embraced the quiet power of melody and lyricism over volume and bravado.

It was Elliott Smith, Jeff Tweedy, Sufjan Stevens, Sam Beam of Iron & Wine, and a childhood fascination with Jack Johnson that led him down this path, and it has made Off-Ramp his first full-length studio album since graduating from the University of Washington in 2016.

Growing up under the dual influence of African American and Filipino traditions, Catchings' voice is not robust or soulful like many others in those cultural backgrounds. Instead, he discovered a unique vocal approach that has become Off-Ramp's signature: a soft and nuanced presence that cuts through even when its carrier is a small voice.

This musical journey began with a desire to heal, a form of self-soothing through songwriting, but soon became his primary creative outlet. At 35, he assumed it was too late to start a serious music career after years of academic pursuits. Yet, Off-Ramp marked the beginning of his return to his true passion.

The album is produced by Grammy-winning jazz pianist Ruslan Sirota and features a rotating cast of seasoned musicians, including Ryan Lerman (producer for Lizzy McAlpine), Chaun Horton (Natasha Bedingfield), and Goh Nakamura (composer for Greatest Night in Pop). Each song on the album offers a glimpse into Catchings' emotional depth, blending storytelling with delicate melodies. "



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

ECHOES OF ANTIQUITY: BRIAN NOYES BUILDS A WORLD OF SOUND

Brian Noyes occupies a sonic space both deeply rooted in tradition and startlingly modern, crafting music that feels simultaneously familiar and utterly unique. Emerging from the vibrant musical landscape of Seattle, Washington, Noyes is building an increasingly compelling body of work, bolstered by three absorbing albums, underpinned by a keen understanding of melody and texture. The current trajectory points towards a richly detailed artistic vision, one that rewards patient listeners with layers of atmosphere and emotional resonance.

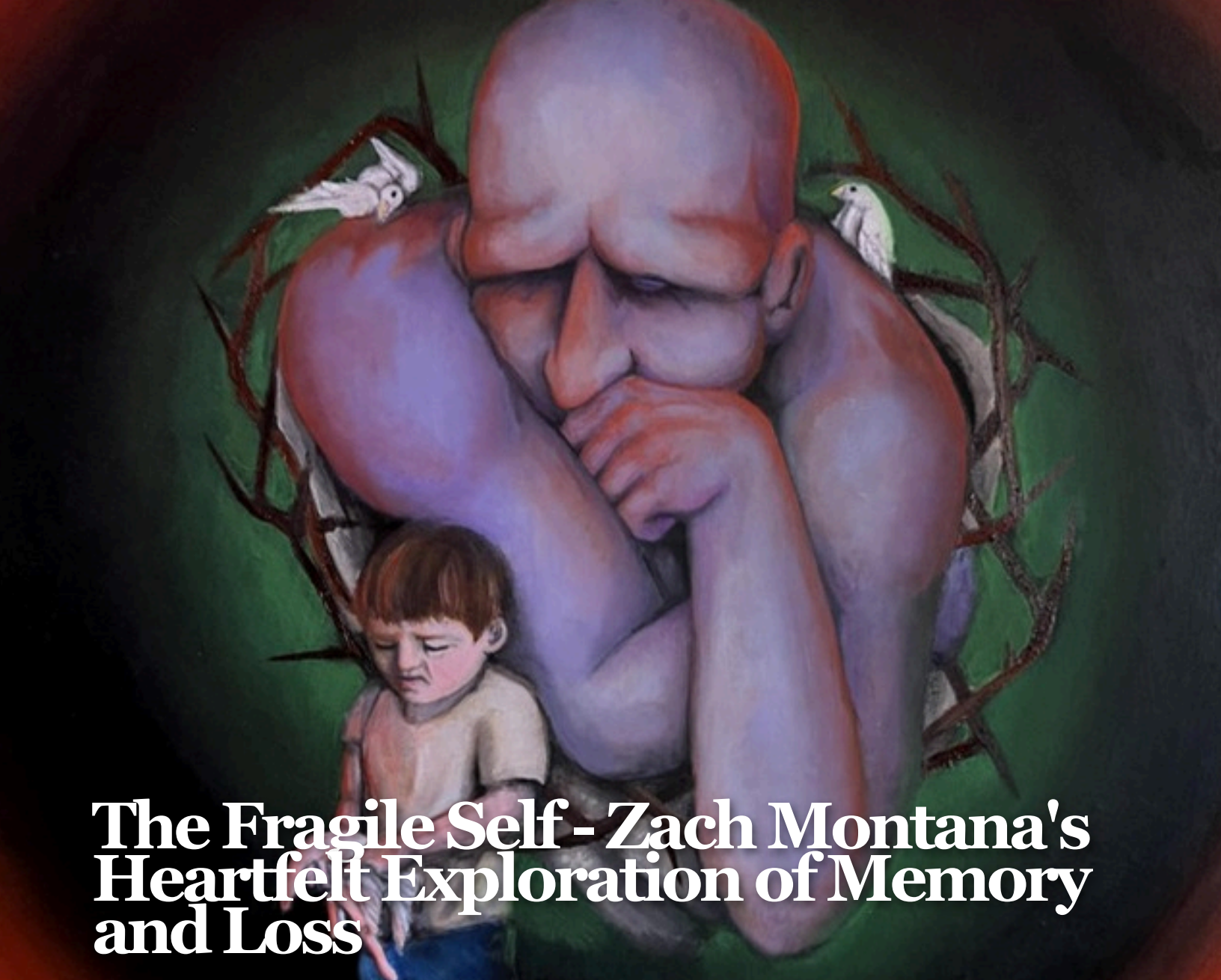
Noyes' established presence within the psych-pop scene is immediately apparent. A member of the intriguing band Tomten alongside his work as touring keyboardist for Papercuts speaks to a versatile musical sensibility. This experience, coupled with a deep appreciation for artists such as Nick Drake, John Cale, and The Clientele, figures who command attention for their evocative songwriting, informs every aspect of Noyes' creative process.

The meticulous construction of sound is a cornerstone of his work. Early recordings, including the 2020 debut self-titled album, showcased a mastery of instrumentation, deploying instruments such as Mellotron, piano, nylon string guitar, and synths with an almost baroque precision. Subsequent releases continue this trend, amplified by collaborations that elevate the sonic palette to even greater heights. The recently released 'Seelie Court', a captivating collection of lush psych-pop tracks supported by contributions from Alvays and Sugar Candy Mountain, exemplifies this, a record hailed by KEXP as "a well-crafted collection of psych-tinged baroque-pop."

His latest offering, 'The Ringing World,' promises to further consolidate this approach. Produced collaboratively with engineer and co-producer Nicholas Wilbur, the album features an impressive array of session musicians including former members of La Luz, Alvays, and Sugar Candy Mountain, a testament to Noyes' ability to cultivate a truly collaborative atmosphere.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



The Fragile Self - Zach Montana's Heartfelt Exploration of Memory and Loss



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

If you heard Zach Montana at a pivotal moment in your life, you might cry. The Arizona-based alternative artist has built a singular and unsettling artistic world, one deeply rooted in purist songwriting yet relentlessly pushing against convention. His latest album, *Sum of Parts*, isn't merely music; it's an excavation, a careful, sometimes brutal, examination of the fragments that constitute a person, both past and present. The core of *Sum of Parts* lies in its relentless exploration of contradiction. Across twelve tracks,

Montana confronts the inherent tensions within human experience: the desperate need for connection juxtaposed with self-imposed isolation, the yearning for change alongside ingrained destructive patterns, and the bittersweet comfort found even within the most painful memories. This tension is immediately evident in "Odin," where the repeated refrain, "To sum our parts is agony", sets the tone for a record devoted to embracing discomfort. Montana's songwriting isn't about easy answers. His approach is visceral, confronting themes of

physical deterioration, addiction, grief, and loneliness with unflinching honesty. Yet, amidst this darkness, there's a persistent thread of beauty, a willingness to acknowledge humor, forgiveness, and the possibility of transformation. "Son," perhaps the album's most striking track, embodies this perfectly. Beginning as a hushed acoustic meditation, "Hold my breath and count to three", it builds into a sprawling rock epic fueled by yearning and regret. The song's power resides in its ambiguity.

Q&A

Light the Fire: DMGDZ Ignites a Global Protest Anthem



The music scene is rarely silent, but when confronted with escalating global anxieties, it often feels as though voices of dissent are muffled. Enter DMGDZ, a rising rap collective forging a path through the noise with their latest offering, “Light the Fire,” a track that doesn’t just sound like protest, it embodies it. Released on July 17th, 2026, this single marks the explosive first glimpse of what is to come from DMGDZ alongside Mat Wav’s upcoming album *BREAK IN CASE OF EMERGENCY*. The collective’s vision isn’t merely musical; it’s a direct challenge to the established order.

The impetus for “Light the Fire” stemmed from a profound frustration within the group

regarding the relative silence surrounding global atrocities, and that urgency translates directly into the track’s visceral production. Recorded in Montreal with renowned engineer Murker Music, the soundscape is relentlessly powerful, a deliberate blend of dubstep’s intensity, drill music’s raw aggression, and dancehall’s infectious bounce. Mat Wav handled both production and mastering from Toronto, layering expertly crafted beats beneath the storm.

At its core, “Light the Fire” is anchored by Grizzy Wynter’s distinctive vocal delivery. His approach is intentionally off-kilter, a quarter-second delay applied to his vocals, meticulously calibrated to perfectly ride the

hybrid rhythm with surgical precision. This technique adds an unnerving edge, reflecting both vulnerability and unwavering conviction. Layered over this relentless drive is a haunting gospel vocal sample, subtly amplifying the song’s emotional weight.

The thematic heart of the single lies in its powerful metaphor: fire as a force of both devastation and renewal. DMGDZ utilizes this imagery to confront issues of wealth concentration, institutional corruption, and systemic injustice head-on. The track functions as an urgent call for accountability, framed by a fervent belief that the power ultimately resides with the people.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

The Bastas Project's Heavy Machinery: Family, Neon Noir & Endurance in Melodic Rock

In the heart of Woodstock, Georgia, a family band is crafting music that captures the tension between intimacy and industrial might. The Bastas Project's latest release, *Heavy Machinery*, is an eight-track album released on August 11, 2026, by the project's four founding members: James Bastas (vocals), his wife Lauren (piano/keyboards), their daughter Ella (guitar/vocals) and son Jake (drums/guitars). The album's striking cover image features an industrial press bearing down on a small digital clock frozen at 3:47, still glowing. This moment of pressure and resilience is emblematic of the record's overarching theme, a sonic exploration of what refuses to break under any circumstance.

Heavy Machinery weaves together starkly industrial sounds with melodic hooks, creating a unique blend that sets it apart from more conventional rock albums. The title track, *Rise Up*, serves as an immediate and powerful opening, setting the tone for the album's sonic journey. As the song progresses, the band's familiar vocal harmonies come to life, underscoring the album's central theme of resilience against adversity.

The album is divided into two distinct halves. The first half, *Heavy Machinery*, *Rust & Neon* and *Shadow's Dance*, builds a dark, neon-lit tension that mirrors the industrial machinery bearing down on the clock. These tracks are characterized by their raw, gritty guitars and an electronic wash of synths, creating a sonic backdrop that is both immersive and chilling.

By contrast, the second half, *Unbreakable*, *Rivers of Gold* and *Keep Your Gold*, delivers anthemic choruses that offer a sense of hope and redemption. These tracks are characterized by their melodic structures, soaring vocals and uplifting instrumentation, offering listeners a glimpse into the album's more hopeful side.

At the heart of *Heavy Machinery* is *I am your Calendar*, an intimate and tender moment in the album's narrative arc. This song reflects the Bastas Project's ability to tap into complex emotions through their harmonized vocals,

creating a sense of authenticity that resonates deeply with listeners who can relate to its themes.

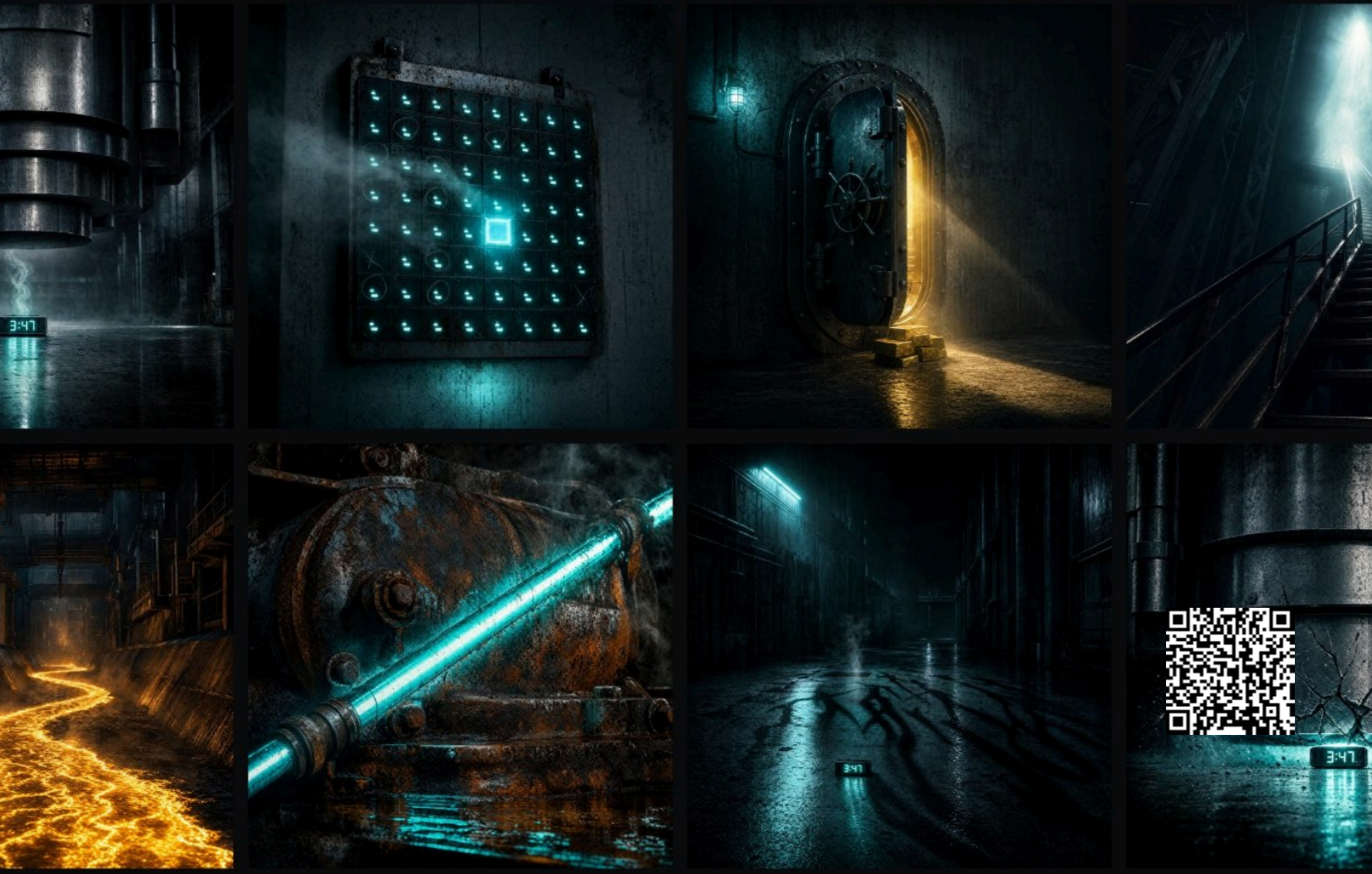
The Bastas Project's music is not just about crafting songs; it is also a reflection of their own familial journey. The group's creative process is infused with the dynamic between family members who have grown up together, sharing a deep understanding and connection that translates into meaningful musical expressions. This familial bond is evident in the album's sonic textures, which are characterized by close harmonies and an intimate feel.

The Bastas Project has carved out a distinct niche within contemporary music with their unique blend of melodic rock and industrial sounds. They have received praise for their emotional depth and storytelling ability, with critics describing them as "emotional pop-rock" and "melodic rock." Their latest release, *Heavy Machinery*, is a testament to the power of family dynamics in shaping both personal and artistic expression.

Fans who are intrigued by the Bastas Project's music will want to start their exploration with *Rise Up* for immediate impact. For a more immersive experience that explores the album's full range of emotions, they should then turn to *Heavy Machinery*, *Rust & Neon* and *Shadow's Dance*. Those seeking something more uplifting can find solace in *Unbreakable*, *Rivers of Gold* and *Keep Your Gold*.

Listening guide: Listen first to *Rise Up* for a taste of the Bastas Project's ability to deliver immediate impact. Then move on to *Heavy Machinery*, where industrial might meets melodic hooks. Afterward, return to the album's more hopeful moments with *Unbreakable*, *Rivers of Gold* and *Keep Your Gold*.

Heavy Machinery is not just an album; it is a journey that begins under pressure but finds its way towards redemption. With each track, The Bastas Project invites listeners into their world, sharing stories about family, resilience and the enduring power of music to connect us all.



LONG READ

Remain: A Ritual in Sound



What happens when pop music stops trying to demand attention? Jon Darc's work, particularly as revealed through the hypnotic and profoundly moving 'Remain', offers a strikingly different experience, one that feels less like an event designed for mass consumption and more akin to a carefully orchestrated ritual. This Berlin-based performance artist is building a world where emotional resonance trumps sonic spectacle, crafting immersive narratives that blend music, fashion, movement, and visual art into a single, compelling whole.

The emotionally charged EP MORAST hinted at this burgeoning aesthetic, a radical shift toward quieter contemplation, but 'Remain' solidifies Darc's position as a powerful voice navigating the intersection of experimental pop, performance art, and

queer culture. It's a sound piece that deliberately suspends itself between dream and awakening, an invitation to stillness and awareness.

At its core, 'Remain' explores the universal yearning for permanence, acknowledging the inescapable passage of time with haunting beauty. The cyclical mantra, "Earth lays dreaming / Sun wakes gleaming", immediately establishes a connection to natural rhythms; a quiet meditation on sleep, renewal, and decay. This isn't simply about a song, but about a state of being.

The production is masterful in its restraint. Warm, ethereal synths drift and shimmer alongside grainy vocals and delicate falsetto textures. A steady, almost rock-like drum pattern anchors the track, lending it a surprising sense of gravity despite its otherwise airy quality. The

production breathes, intimate, tactile, and remarkably restrained, letting texture and repetition guide the listener rather than relying on traditional song dynamics.

Darc's background in theatre profoundly informs their artistic practice. Performances are never just concerts; they unfold as immersive rituals, confrontations, or staged fantasies. Fashion becomes a deliberate character element, while sound offers a space where vulnerability and spectacle coexist. Drawing inspiration from queer nightlife, mythology, contemporary performance, and intimate confession, Darc constructs worlds that grapple with potent themes: desire, identity, grief, tenderness, and transformation, specifically the often uncomfortable explorations of control, shame, trauma, and visibility.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL

DEEP DIVE

SETH DAVID BRANITZ LEAVES THE LIGHT ON

After more than 25 years of making music, Seth David Branitz returns with "Nitelite", his first single following a run of five full length albums. For a New York musician rooted in the anti folk tradition, the song arrives less as a dramatic reinvention than as a thoughtful continuation, bringing years of experience to a meditation on love, uncertainty and the complicated decisions that can emerge after decades spent alongside another person.

"Nitelite" finds Branitz looking closely at the less polished side of long term relationships. Time can create familiarity and security, but it can also expose tensions that become increasingly difficult to ignore. The song occupies that uneasy space between affection and frustration, where staying together does not necessarily mean having all the answers. Rather than forcing the story toward a clean resolution, Branitz allows the uncertainty to remain part of the emotional landscape.

The track was co produced by Jack Petrocelli of The Fab Faux, with musicians from the Hudson Valley contributing to its intimate musical setting. Their involvement gives the recording a sense of community and character, supporting a song that depends more on emotional detail than spectacle. The production leaves room for the central idea to develop naturally, creating a restrained atmosphere touched by melancholy without allowing the sadness to overwhelm the song.

At the heart of "Nitelite" is the recognition that commitment can be complicated. Long relationships contain years of shared experience, personal change and accumulated memories, and those layers can

make moments of uncertainty especially difficult to navigate. Branitz does not treat those moments as evidence that everything has failed. Instead, he explores the possibility that continuing to try can itself be meaningful, even when the destination remains unclear.

That idea comes into focus through the song's central image. The nightlight does not eliminate darkness. It simply provides enough illumination to make the darkness easier to face. In Branitz's hands, "leave the nitelite on" becomes an understated metaphor for persistence, suggesting that hope does not always need to arrive as certainty. Sometimes it is simply the decision to keep a small light burning.

"My feet are planted by and by and either way we're gonna try and leave the nitelite on" captures that feeling with remarkable simplicity. The line carries the weight of someone who understands that relationships are not sustained solely through grand gestures. They are also shaped by smaller decisions, by patience, by returning to the conversation and by choosing to keep trying when the easier answer might be to walk away.

That perspective gives the song a mature emotional quality without making it feel detached. Branitz is not observing relationships from a distance. He is interested in their contradictions, the ways love can coexist with confusion and how familiarity can make both comfort and pain more intense. The song's melancholy therefore feels earned rather than manufactured.

His connection to anti folk is also significant. The tradition has long provided space for intimate

songwriting, conversational storytelling and emotional honesty, qualities that suit Branitz's approach to "Nitelite". Rather than relying on grand declarations, the song finds its power in a close examination of ordinary emotional realities. The result is music that feels personal while leaving enough space for listeners to recognize their own experiences within it.

The involvement of Petrocelli and the Hudson Valley musicians adds another dimension to the recording. After spending so many years within New York's musical community, Branitz's return is supported by players who help give the single a sense of place. The arrangement remains focused on the song itself, allowing the musicianship to enhance rather than overshadow its reflective character.

"Nitelite" also carries the perspective of an artist returning after a substantial period of creative history. Five albums and more than 25 years in music provide a different relationship with time than that of an artist just beginning a career. Branitz's new single arrives with an understanding that life changes gradually, that relationships evolve in ways people cannot always predict and that the most meaningful choices are sometimes made without certainty about their consequences.

The song's emotional strength comes from its refusal to simplify those realities. There is no promise that everything will work out perfectly. There is no attempt to transform complicated feelings into an uncomplicated message. Instead, Branitz offers something smaller and perhaps more believable, the willingness to keep going, to remain present and to leave the light on.



SPOTLIGHT

‘Am Ars, Am Ars’: A Universal Language of Heartbreak



The music industry often prioritizes trends and immediate impact, but a rare current shimmer exists, one dedicated to the profound and enduring power of raw emotion. Derelioglu Music isn't chasing fleeting moments; it's excavating the quiet corners of the human experience and presenting them with striking clarity through meticulously crafted contemporary pop. The project's debut single, 'Am Ars, Am Ars,' exemplifies this approach perfectly, establishing a foundation built on atmospheric production, vulnerable vocals, and a melody destined to linger long after the final note fades.

At its core, 'Am Ars, Am Ars' is an unflinching exploration of heartbreak, loss, and the arduous journey towards resilience. The song's strength lies not solely in its lyrical content, entirely penned by the artist, but also in its ability to evoke a deeply intimate listening experience. There's a palpable sense of vulnerability conveyed through the expressive vocals and layered production, creating an atmosphere that simultaneously feels expansive and intensely personal. This isn't merely pop music; it's a deliberate artistic statement. Derelioglu Music has conceived 'Am Ars, Am Ars' as part of a broader multilingual concept, six different languages all converging to express the same fundamental emotion: heartbreak. This ambitious undertaking recognizes that while words may vary across cultures, the core feeling remains universally understood. The project deliberately seeks to bypass linguistic barriers, prioritizing connection through melody and atmosphere above precise translation.

The production itself is masterful, an exercise in building sonic landscapes designed to envelop the listener. AI-assisted tools played a key role throughout the musical production and vocal elements, demonstrating a conscious embracing of modern technology alongside artistic vision. The artist's aim isn't just to create a catchy song; it's to forge a connection with listeners on a deeply emotional level, acknowledging that heartbreak transcends cultural boundaries.

The success of 'Am Ars, Am Ars' relies on its ability to resonate regardless of the listener's comprehension of every word. The strength of the melody, the captivating atmosphere, and perhaps most importantly, the authentic performance all combine to create a visceral experience, a feeling that speaks directly to the soul. It signals an exciting new direction for this independent project, one where music acts as a powerful conduit for shared human experiences, reminding us that sometimes, words truly are unnecessary.



SCAN TO LISTEN
INDIEFFERENTIAL



HOLD THE LINE: A PAINTER'S NERVE IN THE HEART OF SEATTLE'S INDIE SCENE

PHOTO CREDIT: MICHELE CAMPBELL

The soundscape of *Tether the Star* feels simultaneously familiar and strikingly new. Emerging from the vibrant indie-rock scene of Seattle, this trio, maëry lanahan, Brian DeWeese, and Connor Hall, has crafted a debut full-length, *Hold the Line*, that speaks directly to the anxieties of contemporary existence with an unsettling beauty. The album's core tenet, eleven songs exploring self-worth, resistance, and quiet acts of defiance, resonates deeply within its art-pop architecture. It's a project intrinsically linked to maëry lanahan's practice as a visual artist; her painterly eye informs every sonic decision, creating an immersive experience far beyond the typical indie-rock fare.

The music itself is meticulously constructed. *Hold the Line* isn't simply indie rock; it's 'indie-rock built on art-pop bones,' as described by those involved. The arrangements are expansive and cinematic, capable of conjuring sweeping vistas

within a small room, yet always grounded in a distinctly human scale. There's a careful balance struck between tenderness and raw defiance, a dance performed without ever leaning too heavily into either extreme. This tension is palpable throughout the record, driven by lanahan's vocals which are delivered with a startling vulnerability layered with an undeniable force.

The recording process itself was carefully orchestrated at Bear Creek Studio in Woodinville, Washington, during late Fall of 2024. The core lineup, lanahan on songwriting and vocals alongside guitar, piano, and synths; DeWeese providing the rhythmic bedrock on drums; and Cortez anchoring the low end with his bass, was further augmented by Connor Hall who adds a wealth of textural experimentation to the mix. The visual element is integral to the *Tether the Star* identity. Lanahan's involvement extends beyond simply fronting the band; she conceived and

executed the artwork for the album, including a significant 40x80" piece that mirrors the themes explored within the music.

Influences are scattered across the sonic landscape - ranging from the meticulously crafted art rock of the 80s to the introspective alternative sensibilities of the 90s, and ultimately informed by a contemporary indie aesthetic. But it's lanahan's unwavering commitment to storytelling that truly distinguishes *Tether the Star*. *Hold the Line* demonstrates a profound understanding of capturing nuanced emotions, exploring the quiet battles fought within ourselves in a world designed to undermine our confidence. The current live lineup, incorporating Hall on synths and keys, promises an even more immersive experience, suggesting a continued commitment to pushing boundaries between sound and image.

KATIE NOIR

Katie Noir Steps Into the Aftermath of Vulnerability

There is a particular kind of vulnerability that begins after the confession has already been made. The words have been spoken, the private thoughts have become public, and there is no longer any way to return to the safety of keeping everything hidden. For Katie Noir, that moment becomes the starting point for *The Aftermath EP*, the second chapter in an evolving musical world that began with her deeply personal debut album, *What Is Unseen Still Exists*.

At just 21, the German artist is already approaching songwriting as something considerably larger than the creation of individual tracks. A medical student as well as a musician, Noir turns overthinking, memory, emotion and the thoughts she never quite knew how to express into an expansive body of work. Her music moves through alternative pop, art pop, dark pop, electronic pop, R&B, hip hop and cinematic songwriting, but genre is ultimately secondary to the emotional narrative connecting everything together.

The Aftermath EP makes that approach particularly clear. Across 15 tracks, Noir explores reality, vulnerability, healing, loyalty and acceptance, examining what can happen when the internal world she once kept private begins interacting with the outside world. The project is not presented as a collection of songs left behind after the completion of her debut. Instead, it exists as a direct consequence of it.

That distinction is central to understanding the EP. *What Is Unseen Still Exists* opened the door into Noir's inner life, creating a 23 song concept album concerned with friendship, mistakes, loneliness, meaning, hope and the hidden experiences that continue to matter even

when nobody else can see them. Once that world was released, however, it no longer belonged entirely to her. Other people could hear it, interpret it and respond to it.

The Aftermath begins in that space between expression and consequence.

The project considers the fear that can follow emotional exposure, particularly when the things that once felt safe inside your own mind are suddenly available for other people to examine. There is an inherent tension in turning private pain into something public. Music can transform difficult experiences into something meaningful, but the process can also make the original emotions feel newly vulnerable.

Noir does not appear interested in resolving that contradiction too quickly. Instead, she allows the aftermath to become its own emotional territory. The songs move through disappointment, friendship and betrayal, grief, self abandonment and the complicated recognition of the people who remain when circumstances become difficult.

That focus on relationships gives the project a particularly human quality. Loyalty can be comforting, but it can also reveal how much we expect from other people. Betrayal can change the way someone understands friendship, while grief can alter the meaning of memories that once seemed uncomplicated. Even healing is treated as something less straightforward than simply moving on.

The result is a project concerned with emotional consequences rather than easy conclusions.

Noir's songwriting is particularly suited to that kind of exploration because her music functions as part of a larger emotional world. Individual songs can stand independently, but they also contribute to a narrative that becomes more complete when heard as a whole. That gives *The Aftermath EP* a cinematic quality, not necessarily because every moment is grand, but because the project is structured around atmosphere, progression and emotional perspective.

Her movement between alternative pop, dark pop, electronic music, R&B and hip hop gives her plenty of sonic territory in which to explore those ideas. Rather than treating these styles as separate identities, Noir uses them as different shades within the same creative palette. A darker electronic atmosphere can reflect isolation, while a more melodic passage can make room for tenderness or acceptance. The genre shifts become part of the storytelling.

There is also something striking about the scale of Noir's ambitions at such an early point in her career. Her debut album contains 23 tracks, already establishing a substantial conceptual universe, while the 15 track *Aftermath EP* continues that narrative rather than abandoning it for something entirely new. The projects suggest an artist who thinks in terms of emotional architecture, where songs are connected by themes and experiences rather than simply assembled into a release.

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Ava Valianti Turns Infatuation Into a New Musical Perspective

Ava Valianti's latest chapter begins with an unusual reversal of perspective. At 17, she is already familiar with the idea of performing, building an audience and imagining a future in music, yet her new single "celebrity" asks what happens when the person on the other side of that equation suddenly becomes the one who feels larger than life. Rather than examining fame from the perspective of someone seeking it, Valianti turns inward, exploring the intoxicating experience of placing another person on a pedestal until even their smallest gestures seem significant.

"celebrity" is built around that familiar but difficult to define feeling of seeing someone through a rose colored lens. Infatuation has a way of altering scale. A passing look can feel meaningful, an ordinary interaction can become something worth replaying, and a person who might otherwise be one presence among many can gradually occupy an extraordinary amount of emotional space. Valianti captures that shift with an imaginative approach to songwriting, using the language of celebrity to describe a deeply personal experience of fascination.

The concept carries an added layer of irony because Valianti herself is pursuing a life in which she may one day be viewed through that same lens. As an independent singer songwriter from Massachusetts, she has already experienced the early stages of building a career in music, from performing live to reaching listeners far beyond her home region. "celebrity" gives her an opportunity to step outside that experience and consider fame from the opposite direction. The song becomes less about celebrity in the conventional sense and more about the strange power one person can acquire when admiration becomes intense enough.

Musically, the single also signals a change in direction. It is the first release from Valianti's forthcoming third EP, "kismet", and introduces a warmer sound shaped by jazz

and R&B influences. That shift expands on the introspective qualities already present in her writing without abandoning the storytelling that has remained central to her work. Rather than treating genre as a fixed identity, Valianti has allowed each stage of her young career to develop its own character, creating a musical progression that reflects her continued growth as both a writer and performer.

Her debut EP, "petunias", established an introspective indie pop foundation, while "Sophomore Slump" moved into a more guitar driven pop rock setting. "kismet" now points somewhere more soulful, suggesting an artist becoming increasingly comfortable with contrast. The music can change shape while the writing remains anchored in observation, emotional detail and the imaginative interpretation of everyday experiences.

There is an almost dreamlike quality to the idea at the heart of the song. Idolization can feel exhilarating because it transforms ordinary reality. Someone becomes more interesting, more important and more mysterious through the imagination of the person watching them. Yet that same process can distort perception. When admiration becomes powerful enough, the actual person can become difficult to distinguish from the version created in the mind. Valianti's songwriting finds interest in that tension, allowing the song to exist between romance, fantasy and self awareness.

Her previous releases have already introduced listeners to an artist interested in documenting the interior world rather than simply describing external events. With "celebrity", that inward focus remains intact even as the musical palette expands. Jazz and R&B provide new textures for her storytelling, offering space for a more relaxed and soulful expression while preserving the lyrical imagination that has shaped her earlier work.

INTERVIEW

A conversation with MILYAM

Full Interview at
www.indiefferential.com

What is a typical day in your life as an artist?

"It's far less glamorous than people think and demands absolute discipline. I don't just write songs; I run MILYAM EMPIRE. Right now, for instance, I'm in the Dominican Republic shooting a music video, so my days are a mix of directing on set, juggling calls across time zones, and writing new songs. My team and I are deeply involved in everything — from creative direction to negotiating our own PR deals. A typical day comes down to building the empire, piece by piece."

How would you define success? What is your goal?

"At this moment, I am incredibly proud that 'Intimacy' is a Semi-Finalist in the R&B/Soul category of Unsigned Only 2026. It's a real milestone. But ultimately, success is absolute creative and financial autonomy on a global scale. My goal isn't just to have a fleeting hit; it's to establish MILYAM EMPIRE as a powerhouse label, retain 100% ownership of both my masters and my publishing, and bring my cinematic vision to the world's biggest stages. I want to reach a level of success and influence where my family — who make up my core team — will have complete freedom, and where my artistic choices are never compromised by industry pressure."

AI is changing the creative process and challenging ideas of originality. What do you think a human artist can offer that AI never will?

"Only a human can make a sound that's genuinely emotive. AI assembles what already exists; a human artist takes risks and makes mistakes, and it's precisely out of that risk that something new is born. They can push music in new directions, blending genres based on their authentic vision and personal experiences. This stems from how they perceive the world and the genuine emotions they've lived through. I think this breath of fresh air — this visceral sound that actually cuts through — is exactly what new artists bring to the industry."







A Different Kind of Beautiful

Piper Connolly has no interest in sanding down the rough edges of growing up. Her new EP, "she's too much!", takes the phrase often directed at girls who feel intensely, speak honestly or refuse to make themselves more convenient and turns it into something far more powerful. Across six songs, Connolly embraces contradiction rather than trying to resolve it, moving through confidence and insecurity, attraction and betrayal, humor and heartbreak with the kind of emotional immediacy that makes adolescence feel both exhilarating and overwhelming.

The EP's title establishes its central idea, but the music gives that idea shape. Connolly works within a world of alt pop and pop rock, combining sharp hooks with live guitar energy and a strong instinct for melody. The songs feel immediate without being emotionally simple. Beneath their accessible structures is a young artist wrestling with the messy process of figuring out who she is while everything around her continues to change.

That sense of movement is present from the opening moments of "beautiful life", where exhilaration and uncertainty exist side by side. Elsewhere, "body bag" pushes toward a darker pop rock atmosphere, while "unapologetic" approaches self assertion with a directness that matches the EP's larger philosophy. Connolly does not present confidence as something permanent or effortless. Instead, it appears as something that can emerge in the middle of doubt, disappointment and emotional chaos.

The focus track, "bubblegum with razorblades", distills that tension particularly well. Its title suggests sweetness with danger underneath, and the song follows through on that contrast. An addictive chorus gives it an immediate pop appeal, but there is a sharper emotional current running beneath the surface. Connolly understands that vulnerability does not have to mean softness and that something playful can still carry an edge.

That duality extends into the visual presentation surrounding the song. The accompanying music video reflects Connolly's creative involvement across the concept, imagery, styling and performance, building a world where candy coated surfaces meet unruly energy and darker undertones. The visual language mirrors the song itself, presenting something bright and inviting while allowing its more complicated emotions to remain visible.

"joyride" and "better than this" complete the EP's portrait of a young person moving through change without pretending to have every answer. Together, the six songs create a record concerned with self invention, but not the polished version of transformation that often appears in hindsight. Connolly is interested in the confusion that happens while the transformation is still underway, when confidence can disappear as quickly as it arrives and when one experience can completely change the way another is understood.

That honesty is central to what makes her music feel connected to contemporary youth culture without reducing it to a particular moment. Connolly writes about experiences that can be intensely personal while still recognizing their wider emotional familiarity. Feeling like too much, caring too deeply, wanting freedom while discovering its consequences, falling for someone and then dealing with what happens when trust breaks are all part of the emotional landscape she explores.

Her approach is also reflected in the contrast between her recordings and her live presence. Connolly has developed into a commanding performer who brings the immediacy of a live band into music built around strong pop instincts. The result is a performance style that does not separate polish from intensity. Her songs can be melodic and accessible while still retaining the grit that gives them character.

That momentum has been growing steadily around her music. The Phoenix born, Los Angeles based artist has received coverage from LADYGUNN, EARMILK, Atwood Magazine and We Found New Music, while her songs have received editorial support across Apple Music playlists including Fresh Blood, New In Rock, New In Alternative, New In Pop and New In Hard Rock. "beautiful life" reached an international audience through a five week run on South Africa's 5FM Top 40, while "body bag" received a Hollywood Independent Music Award nomination for Best Alternative Song.

Connolly was also selected as Meta's Artist of the Day in July, bringing her music and story to an audience of 5.8 million. With more than 360,000 followers across her platforms and more than 1.7 million social views during a recent 30 day period, her growing audience is responding to more than individual songs. The connection also comes from her humor, creative

process and willingness to show the personality behind the music.

That distinction matters because Connolly's appeal is closely tied to the sense that the songs belong to a larger creative world. She is not simply delivering finished recordings and stepping away. Her involvement in the visual presentation, performance and storytelling allows the personality behind the music to remain present throughout the project. The result is an artist whose identity feels connected to the entire experience rather than confined to the tracks themselves.

"she's too much!" ultimately works because Connolly does not attempt to resolve the tensions that shape it. Growing up can be contradictory, and the EP allows those contradictions to remain intact. A song can be funny and painful. Confidence can coexist with insecurity. Something sweet can contain something dangerous. Wanting independence can mean discovering consequences. None of these ideas needs to cancel the others.

Instead, Connolly turns that instability into momentum. Her pop instincts give the songs their immediacy, while the guitars and emotional directness keep them grounded in something more unruly. The EP feels like a snapshot of identity still being formed, full of moments when the boundaries between who you were, who you are and who you might become are difficult to distinguish.

For an artist building her career from Los Angeles, "she's too much!" serves as both a new chapter and a clear statement of creative intent.

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